

1. Can you describe your role in relation to the research project or projects you have been involved in?

I worked on the Beer project as the lead researcher. My involvement focused on gathering information, speaking with people connected to the case, and helping shape our understanding of how things operated locally

2. At the start of the project, what guidance were you given about how you were expected to document your research work? Can you give an example?

At the beginning, the expectation was simply that our work should be stored somewhere shared so others could access it later. Beyond that, there was not much detail, so I mainly concentrated on understanding the case rather than thinking about how each step should be recorded

3. Can you describe specific situations where documentation came up during the project work? What happened in those moments?

The need to document became more noticeable once our project progressed. Earlier impressions sometimes changed as we learned more, and without notes it was harder to retrace how that shift had happened

4. Based on the final outputs of projects, how usable do you think they are for someone new who has not spoken to the original team? Can you give an example?

The final report explains recycling practices in Romania, but a lot of the background sat in working files rather than in the submission itself. Many of our notes stayed on a shared Google Drive, so without looking at those, it would be harder for someone new to understand how our view developed or what shaped it.

5. Which parts would be difficult for someone new to understand based only on what is written down or stored?

The interpretation part. Why certain things were considered important and others less. Also the local context, which was understood during the research but not included in the final submission. Without being there or talking to us, it would be hard to fully define the context and process..

6. Can you think of an example of an important decision or change during the project, and describe how and where it was documented, if at all?

We decided at some point to focus more on bottle reuse and return systems, instead of recycling in general. This happened slowly, through discussions and learning more about the case. I do not think this was clearly documented as a decision. It just appeared in the work later.

7. If someone new wanted to understand how one important conclusion was reached, what would they need to look at or read?

They would need to see notes, early drafts, and maybe emails or messages where we discussed ideas. A lot of the work was developed through group talk and notes that were captured in shared files but not fully carried into the submission

8. During the project, was it clear who was responsible for documenting what, if anyone? How was that responsibility communicated or decided?

We did not spend much time defining who should document what. As the project moved forward, everyone kept track of their own findings in the way that suited them, so the material naturally spread across different files

9. What tools, templates, or systems were used to document work, and where was everything stored in practice?

As i mentioned most working material ended up on a shared Google Drive, where we stored notes, drafts, and reference items alongside the report itself. Since the final deliverable only reflected part of that material, someone relying solely on it would miss some of the background that informed our understanding.

10. What do you think the purpose of documentation is in these projects? Who do you think benefits from it, if anyone? And what, if anything, motivates students to document their work well?

I think documentation should help others understand the research later. Also for supervisors to see what was done. But it is not always clear why we document, so motivation is not very strong. Students focus more on finishing the project than on documenting every step.

11. Based on your experience, what tends to get lost most often over time, for example context, assumptions, decisions, data, analysis steps, or contacts?

The smaller details fade the fastest, especially the things you notice while being there. After some time, what remains is mostly the report, while those practical impressions are harder to recall.

12. How did documentation fit into the project work overall? Did it feel integrated into the work, or more like something added on top? Why?

It felt added on top. We worked on the research and then later tried to document it. Documentation was not something that guided the work step by step.

13. If you were starting the project again, what would you personally do differently in how you document your work?

I would write more notes during the process, even if they are informal. Especially about why we thought something was important. And I would try to keep everything in one place, so it is easier to follow later.

14. Is there anything about documentation, continuity, or research practice that we have not discussed but that you think is important?

I think in international projects, a lot of understanding comes from being close to the case. If this is not written down, the project loses depth. Documentation should help keep that understanding, not only the final conclusions.